Airwallex Editorial Style Guide

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About the Editorial Style Guide

A strong content style guide defines your brand, differentiates your service or product and creates consistent, cohesive messaging that resonates with your audience.

Use this for guidance when you're:

- Writing blog articles / case studies
- Creating landing pages / advertising assets
- Drafting emails and comms

Writing Goals and Principles

Our overarching goal is to help businesses realise their global potential. Every piece of content we publish should:

1. **Inform**
   Give our readers access to useful information that'll help them make the best decisions for their business. Make it as easy as possible for them to read and digest this information by avoiding jargon and impenetrable language.

2. **Inspire**
   Encourage our readers to think big. Help them imagine a world in which there are no barriers to international expansion. Show them how global success is achievable with Airwallex's products.

3. **Educate**
   Our readers won't always know what Airwallex can do for their company. It's our job to show them. When dealing with complex subjects, use clear, concise language. Do not patronise the reader, but don't write impenetrable sentences for the sake of it. Provide clear explanations for technical terms where necessary and link out to further reading.

4. **Empower**
   Our readers should feel that the sky's the limit. Show them how, with Airwallex at their side, they can take on the global market and win. Use optimistic language that builds a positive picture of the future.

Voice and Tone

Voice and tone are two connected, but slightly different concepts.

Voice

The Airwallex voice represents our brand personality and values and does not change. It is how your audience would describe you.

Tone

The Airwallex tone can change depending on who's reading our content. Just as a person will adjust their tone depending on the situation they find themselves in and the people they're speaking to.

Refer to our 🗒️ Airwallex Brand Tone of Voice Guidelines (July 2025)

Editorial Style Guide

For grammar, spelling, and punctuation, please use the Guardian's editorial style guide.
New updates will be highlighted in orange and refreshed monthly.

NUMBERS

- Spell out the numbers one through nine. For 10 and up, use numerals.
    - This applies to editorial content, such as blogs, eGuides, and whitepapers.
    - Exception: Use numerals
        - In marketing communications, such as ad copy and social posts.
        - For blog H1/H2s with a listicle, *e.g.*
          5 ways to optimise your payment system
          1. …
          2. …
          3. …
        - In tables for better readability.
        - For numerical ranges, *e.g. 1–3 business days, 1–5%*
        - With units of measurement, *e.g. 3 million*
- Spell out million instead of using "m", to avoid confusion with metres. The same applies for billions and trillions.
- Spell out numerals that start a sentence, *e.g. Eleven dwarves make a sandwich.*
    - Exception: A sentence that begins with a calendar year, *e.g. 2021*
- For large numbers, use a hyphen to connect a word ending in "y" to another word, *e.g. twenty-one.*
- Spell out casual expressions, *e.g. A thousand times, no!*

PERCENTAGE

- Use the symbol "%" with numerals: *e.g. 15%, 80.5%.*

REGIONS

- Use "US" instead of "U.S.".
- "Hong Kong" vs "Hong Kong SAR"
    - Use "Hong Kong". Do not refer to it as a country.
    - Refer to Hong Kong as a region, *e.g. Airwallex merchants can now accept Discover® Cards across multiple regions, including Australia, Hong Kong, and Singapore.*

    - If you use the phrase "XX+ [countries]" and it's directly linked to an HKD/HK image or copy, always change it to [region], *e.g. "60+ regions" instead of "60+ countries"*

DATES

- Always use Arabic figures, without st, nd, rd, or th.
- Capitalise months, e.g. *January* and not *january.*
- Do not abbreviate months, e.g. *January* and not *Jan.*
- All markets except the US:
    - Our style is day month year, without commas, *e.g. 21 July 2025.*
    - In specifying periods, we do not repeat the months unless the period stretches across month(s), *e.g. 21 July to 6 August versus 6–10 August*
    - In specifying periods that stretch across two months or longer, we use "to" instead of an en-dash, *e.g. 21 July to 6 August, June to August*
        - For numeric ranges, we use en-dash, *e.g. 1970–2020*
- US only:
    - Our style is month day year, without commas, *e.g. 21 July 2025.*

TIME

- Use numerals, except for noon and midnight.
- Do not use colon to separate hours from minutes. Use period instead, *e.g. 2.30am*

TIME ZONES

- AU
    - Australian Eastern Standard Time - (AEST)
    - Australian Eastern Daylight Savings Time - (AEDT)
    - Australian Western Standard Time Perth (AWST)
    - Australian Central Western Standard Time (ACWST)
    - Australian Central Standard Time - (ACST)
    - Lord Howe Standard Time - (LHST)
- UK
    - Greenwich Mean Time (GMT)
- US
    - Eastern time (ET)
    - Pacific time (PT)
    - Mountain time (MT)
    - Central time (CT)

CURRENCIES

- For most currencies (e.g. yen, yuan, afgani) we spell out the full name rather than using a symbol of abbreviation, *e.g. 100 yuan, 100,000 yen*
    - Exceptions: pound, euro, and dollars.
- For major dollar currencies, we abbreviate dollars like this: US$50, A$50, HK$50, S$50, C$50.
    - Exception:
        - GBP is expressed with the pound sign: £10.50
        - EUR is expressed with the euro sign: €10
- We refer to currencies with their nationality, such as Swiss francs. There's no need to repeat the nationality if it's clear from the context whose currency you're referring to.
- When using more than one currency, distinguish the currencies clearly.
- When referencing an external source, state the currency clearly so that the value isn't misconstrued during localisation, *e.g. use US$200,000 instead of $200,000 when referencing statistics from a US report.*
- If a currency is different from the local currency, state the equivalent in the local currency, *e.g. US$200,000, which is approximately equivalent to S$13,037.55.*
- Use CNY instead of RMB. RMB Is the official name of the currency, CNY is the unit of the currency. Both are used interchangeably, but internally we use CNY. See blog example and how we state CNY as a supported currency in Airwallex Docs.

TERMS

- **buy now, pay later (BNPL)** instead of Buy Now Pay Later, as the first version is more commonly used in editorial publications. Buy now, pay later if it's at the beginning of a sentence.
- **Cashback (one word)** instead of cash-back or cash back.
- **eCommerce** is preferred versus e-commerce or Ecommerce. This applies even if eCommerce is the beginning of a sentence.
- **fintech** is preferred, not FinTech. Fintech if it's at the beginning of a sentence.
- **Payment platform**, not payments platform. We use the singular "payment" when conjoined with other words. Another example: payment processing.
- **Payout vs pay out**
    - Payout (e.g. to accept a payout) = noun form
    - Pay out (e.g. to pay out a vendor) = verb form
- **Programme vs Program**

    - For British English: use “programme” in general. Only use “program” in computing contexts, *e.g. you can program single-use virtual cards to be billed on a specific date*.
    - For American English: use “program” only.
- **Startup** (one word) is preferred.
- **Tokenization** is preferred. Always use “tokenization” regardless of region, as this version is used in computing and data security contexts. Within the industry, this version is used by the PCI Security Standards Council, International Organization for Standardization (ISO) Visa, Mastercard, as well as competitors like Stripe and Adyen.
- **WebApp** instead of Web App or Webapp.

PRODUCT NAMES

We use title case for branded terms:

- Airwallex, Global Accounts, etc.
- Please refer to Airwallex as Airwallex (not the Airwallex system, the Airwallex platform, Airwallex’s system, etc.).
- If using a product name in an EDM, there's no need to say Airwallex Global Accounts. Global Accounts is sufficient if it’s implied that it's an Airwallex product.

PRONOUNS

- When referring to another company or business, use “it” or “its”. The Guardian style guide refers to corporate entities as singular, *e.g. Stripe and its developer-friendly APIs.*
    - Use “them” or “their” when referring to a team as a collective noun, *e.g. The team moved quickly to expand their global reach.*
- When referring to Airwallex, use “we” or “our” (first-person POV):
    - When we talk about our company broadly, use “we”.
    - When we talk about our products/technical capabilities, use “our platform” or “it,” *e.g. “Our platform offers Global Accounts that…”, “Global Accounts is … it lets you…”*

DESIGNATIONS

- We will only use acronyms without explanation for all C-suite and executive positions, unless unclear, *e.g. CEO, CFO, CMO, CTO, VP, AVP, SVP*
- If quoting someone, the designation should be included, *e.g. Juliana Smith, Chief Financial Officer, Disney, EMEA*

- Introduce people with their full names then use their first name only in subsequent references, *e.g. Juliana Smith is the Chief Financial Officer at Disney. Juliana believes faster cross-border payments are essential.*

TITLES

- Brand names in normal font with their usual capitalisation, only capitalise when used at the start of a sentence.
- Titles of magazines, films, books, and television shows in italics.
- Titles of blogs, articles, or webinars in sentence case in italics.
- For all titles, we will use sentence casing. See: Sentence case capitalisation
    - Only capitalise the names of our products, company names, designations, *e.g. "Top 5 Stripe alternatives", "A letter from our CEO".*

ABBREVIATIONS

- Acronyms are usually read as one word: *e.g. North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO)*
    - At first mention, always spell out the words in full and put the acronym in brackets: *e.g. International Bank Account Number (IBAN)*
    - Capitalise the initials of the spelt-out words, especially when it's a proper noun: *e.g. Australian Financial Review (AFR), Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)*
- Initialisms are usually read by saying each letter of the acronym: *e.g. Chief Executive Officer (CEO)*

EMOJIS

- We use emojis in some emails, blogs, and social media posts as a way to add personality and humour. Emojis should never be used in formal customer communications, such as a notification about account suspension.

PUNCTUATION

Ampersand (&)

- Use in marketing communications where appropriate, *e.g. landing page title, ad copy, meta title "Payment Gateways: What Are They & How Do They Work?", image banners*

Apostrophe (')

- For both singular and plural nouns ending in s, add only an apostrophe: *e.g. the girls' toys, states' rights, your business' growth.*
- For singular proper names ending in s, use only an apostrophe: *e.g. Descartes' theories, Kansas' schools.*
- For singular proper names ending in s sounds such as x, ce, and z, use 's: *e.g. Marx's theories, the prince's life.*
- For plurals of a single letter, add 's: *e.g. Mind your p's and q's, the Red Sox defeated the Oakland A's.*
- Do not use for plurals of numbers, or multiple letter combinations: *e.g. the 1980s, EINs.*

Comma (,)

- We use Oxford commas.
- Use a comma to set off a person's hometown and age, *e.g. Jane Doe, Framingham, was absent. Joe Blow, 34, was arrested yesterday.*

Colon (:)

- For **titles and headings**, we **capitalise the first word** after a colon, e.g. *"Cross-border payments: How to expand into the US", "How to sell online globally: A complete guide for businesses".*
- For **body copy**, we use **lowercase** after a colon since the clause after the colon usually **explains, lists, or elaborates** , e.g. "*There were three considerations: expense, time, and feasibility.", "*He promised this: the company will make good all the losses."
- Colons go outside quotation marks unless they are part of the quoted material.

En Dash (–)

- Make an en-dash by striking the hyphen key twice, or use option + hyphen (for Mac), Ctrl + hyphen (for Windows).
- Put a space on either side of the dash, *e.g. Smith offered a plan – it was unprecedented – to raise revenues.*

Hyphen (-)

- Use a hyphen for compound adjectives before the noun: e*.g. well-known actor, full-time job, 20-year sentence.*
- Do not use a hyphen to denote an abrupt change in a sentence. Use an en-dash instead.

Quotation Marks (“ ”)

- In dialogue, each person’s words are placed in a separate paragraph, with quotation marks at the beginning and end of each person’s speech.
- Periods and commas always go within quotation marks .
- Dashes, semicolons, question marks, and exclamation points go within the quotation marks when they apply to the quoted material.
- They go outside when they apply to the whole sentence.
- Use single marks for quotes within quotes: *e.g. She said, "He told me, 'I love you.'"*

Hyperlinks

- Avoid hyperlinks in the introduction, as that may distract readers from continuing.
- Use hyperlinks only for sources from non-competing organisations.
- When referencing content from competitors (e.g. for a comparison article), only add the sources as footnotes.

Footnotes and citations

- Use Chicago-style footnotes in white papers and reports.
    - Full Name(s) of author(s), ‘Title of article’ (link), Name of publication/website, date of publication
    - *e.g. Ivan Draganov, ‘Fintech and online marketplaces, a lucrative pairing’, Dealroom, 22 September 2021*
- If the article has no author:
    - ‘Title of article’ (link), Name of publication/website, date of publication
    - *e.g. ‘Online travel market size worldwide from 2020 to 2022, with a forecast for 2023 and 2030,' Statista, 30 August 2023*

Things to look out for

Using too many adjectives

Always consider what meaning an adjective adds to your copy. Overused adjectives lose meaning and create unnatural sentences.

We offer seamless multi-currency accounts, effortless integration options, and enhanced automation tools.

We offer multi-currency accounts, integration options, and automation tools.

Avoid nominalisations

If a noun can be a verb, consider rewriting it with verb forms.

- Implication = implicate
- Have an impact = impact
- Ability = can

The implications of this decision can have an impact on your ability to stay competitive in the future.

This decision can impact your future competitiveness.

Shorter and simpler is better

Think of what you really want to say, and use the least amount of words.

APIs streamline the process of accessing data, automating aspects so that less resources are required to offer a service.

APIs automate access to data, reducing manual work.

Avoid platitudes

Platitudes are vague. Be specific. Overused platitudes include:

- X increases productivity/efficiency
- X optimises your finances
- X adds flexibility to your processes

Instead, tell your reader how. Bonus if you don't use the platitude.

Single-use virtual cards add flexibility if customers need to cancel parts of their booking or defer payments.

If a customer cancels part of a booking, such as a walking tour, the vendor can refund that portion back to the corresponding single-use virtual card.

Language preferences

Choose words that make us sound relatable, natural, and straight-speaking:

- Also, on top of that, and, instead of “additionally”, “furthermore”
- But, though, instead of “however”, “on the contrary”
- Use, instead of “utilise”
- Lets you, instead of “enables you to”, “allows you to”
- Avoid using "smart" or "smarter", as it may come off as condescending to some audience.

Legal Requirements

For legal guidelines by region, please refer to this document.

SEO/GEO Best Practices

See Growth Content Best Practices for a comprehensive guide.

Email Communications Best Practices

Avoid over-branding

Don't use "Airwallex" in the body copy as it’s already clear the email is from us.

Airwallex Global Accounts let you...

Global Accounts let you...
(Or, just refer to “our solutions”, “your account”, “the platform”)

Lead with the benefit, not the feature

Airwallex Corporate Cards help you manage spend.

Easily manage team spend with Corporate Cards. No paperwork, no delays.

Use short, clear sentences

Airwallex Global Accounts help users receive multi-currency international payments faster into Airwallex Business Account.

Receive international payments faster and directly through your Global Accounts.

Keep it focused

Stick to one goal per email and a single CTA where possible.

Action-oriented

- Especially with lifecycle emails, ensure every email is geared for conversion, and doesn't intend to take recipients on a journey through the email messages.
- We'd rather they convert with the first email and get taken out of the email flow than receive the whole series.

Formatting Conventions

Headings

- **Title** – use default heading 1 on Contentful.
- **Subheading** – use default Heading 2 on Contentful.
- This will ensure that the headings will show up in your Table of Contents.
- If you don't want the heading to show up in the Table of Contents, use Heading 3.
- All headings should be in sentence case.
- **Standfirst/deck** (sits just below the title and acts as a teaser that leads into the main content) – use default Heading 4 + italics on Contentful (see example).

Key Takeaways

Keep the Key Takeaways section at the start of the introduction for each blog.

Lists

- Use the default, which are bullet points.
- No fullstops are required in lists unless they're full sentences.

Quotes

- Use the quotes function on Contentful, and add line breaks before and after the quote.
- Follow this format (see example)

"Quote from person." – **Name**, title, company

Spacing

Use the default, which is double-space between every paragraph.

Writing About Airwallex

Airwallex is one word, with a capital A and all other letters lower case.
Product names are always capitalised.

<u>Airwallex Product Brand Segmentation</u>

Business Accounts

1. Global Accounts
2. FX & Transfers
3. Yield

Spend

1. Corporate Cards (previously Borderless Cards)
    a. Employee Cards
    b. Company Cards
2. Expense Management
3. Bill Pay
4. Purchase Orders

Payments

1. Checkout
2. Payment Plugins
3. Payment Links

Billing

1. Invoicing
2. Subscription Management
3. Usage-Based Billing

Platform APIs and Embedded Finance

1. Connected Accounts
2. Accounts
3. Payments
4. Transactional FX
5. Issuing
6. Payouts

Use cases

1. Global Treasury
2. Banking as a Service ("Financial Accounts as a Service" in the US)
3. Payments for Platforms

Airwallex fast facts

Extracted from the Airwallex Company Data page from Corporate Affairs.

Our Infrastructure

- Payments
  - Processing payments with all major schemes like Visa, Mastercard, and Amex, and **160+ local payment methods**
  - Collect payments in **130+ currencies**
  - Settle like-for-like in **20+ currencies**
  - Accept payments from **180+ countries**

- Global Accounts
  - Open domestic and foreign currency accounts in **21 countries** within minutes
  - Accept currencies from **70+ countries**.
  - Open accounts with local bank details to receive funds in 20+ currencies (Note: This line is not from Corp Affairs, but is often used in writing)
  - **59** countries supported with Direct Debit in
  - **56** countries supported with Direct Debit out

- FX Engine
  - **90+** trade currencies supported at interbank rates
  - Save up to **80%** on FX fees
  - **90+** currencies priced live on the spot market
  - **20+** currencies priced live for forwards

- Transfers
  - Pay out to **200+** countries, with **120+** countries leveraging local rails
  - **94%** of our transactions go through local rails (instead of SWIFT)
  - Approximately **93%** of transactions arrive within a few hours/same day
  - Approximately **45%** of transactions are instant

- Spend
    - Corporate cards: Issue multi-currency company and employee cards in **60+ markets**
    - **39** countries directly supported with digital wallets (Apple Pay & Google Pay)

- Licences and relationships
    - **80** licences and permits globally
    - **50+** relationships with banks and financial institutions

- US$235 billion global payments volume processed annually (as of October 2025)

- US$1 billion in annualised revenue (as of October 2025)

- We serve 200,000+ businesses worldwide

People and growth

- Over 2,000 employees globally, across 26 offices

Strong investor backing

- Raised US$1.4 billion; US$8 billion valuation (as of Series G, Dec 2025)
- Investors include: Addition, T. Rowe Price Associates Inc., Activant, Lingotto, Robinhood Ventures, TIAA Ventures, Sequoia, DST Global, Greenoaks Capital, Hedosophia, Salesforce Ventures, Lone Pine Capital, Square Peg, Airtree, Blackbird, Visa and Mastercard.